



Notification Waiver Determination

Hillhouse - Barwon Investment Partners

Acquisition	Barwon Bidco Pty Ltd (Bidco), which is ultimately owned by Hillhouse Investment Management, Ltd (Hillhouse), applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of a majority interest in Barwon Investment Partners Pty Ltd (Barwon), as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	19 May 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Hillhouse, is a global alternative investment manager that deploys capital across multiple strategies, including public equities, private equity, private credit, and real assets. Through its private equity arm, Hillhouse invests in long-term global opportunities across the business services, healthcare, consumer, and industrials sectors. The target, Barwon, is a specialist fund manager investing in alternative assets across healthcare property, real estate credit and global investments, as well as in private equity for institutional and wholesale investors. Both parties supply investment management services in Australia, although their focus is on different asset classes and in different sectors.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: - there is no or limited horizontal overlap between Hillhouse and Barwon's respective services and investment portfolios (including between their connected entities) - there are alternative suppliers of investment management services in Australia - there appears to be a low risk of foreclosure or other concerning vertical or conglomerate effects resulting from exclusionary conduct post-acquisition.

Notification waiver determination | Hillhouse - Barwon Investment Partners (WA-65015)

	The ACCC has also had regard to the likelihood that, if the Acquisition were put into effect, the notification thresholds determined under section 51ABP(1) of the Act would apply. While the ACCC considers that the notification thresholds are likely to be met, given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act